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MAN O' WAR

NORSE RAIDERS

By Andy Jones

The northern regions of the Old World suffer from extremes of climate and geography unlike anywhere else. The dense dark forests, high barren mountains, icy seas and long winter nights conspire to make life both hard and short. This cruel land is home to the Norse – a race of men that are as fierce, brutal and unforgiving as the landscape itself.

Because little grows upon the rocky soil of the North, the Norse have traditionally turned to the sea for their livelihood. Their Kingships and Longships set out for the shores of Albion, the coasts of the Old World, and even further afield, bringing warriors to pillage and extort what they require.

Occasionally they will trade with other races, or hire themselves out as mercenaries in return for goods, but most of the time they will simply fight to get what they want. It is said that the Norse love war, song and ale; but most of all they love war.

Old Worlders tell horrifying tales of these berserk warriors from over the Sea of Claws, looting and burning from their dragon-headed vessels, and ravaging the northern coasts of The Empire and Kislev.

The Norse are known as excellent sailors and fearless warriors, given to great voyages and adventures; the most wayward of the Norse raiders have sailed as far as Ulthuan and The Southlands, bringing home tales of strange lands, immeasurable wealth and wild creatures.

The Norsemen's skills make them ideal recruits for any navy, and as a result Norse warriors are found fighting for the highest bidder in many sea battles. A Norseman's first love is battle, whether it is as a mercenary, an ally, or as a follower of the Plaguefleets of Chaos.

Longships excel in boarding actions and are fairly fast, being able to move under both oars and sail. Each carries many warriors; bloodthirsty fighters able to turn their hand equally to oar or sword. The Norse scorn the use of cannons aboard their ships, in order to keep them as light as possible for greater manoeuvrability.

NORSE SHIPS

Norse ships make a useful addition to your warfleet if you plan to get stuck into some heavyweight boarding actions. They are generally used as allies for other races, but if you want to have a fleet made up entirely of Norse ships, we have included a Norse Fleet List. There are two types of Norse ship: the Kingship, which is a Man O' War, and the Longship, which is a Ship of the Line. They are similar in appearance, but the Kingship is much more powerful in battle.

Unless specifically contradicted here, all the normal Man O' War rules apply to Norse ships.

MOVEMENT

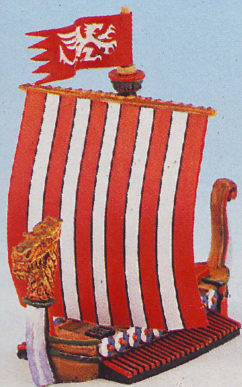
Norse ships have a very shallow draft. They can sail in dangerously shallow waters and beach on remote shores without damaging their hulls. To represent this, the normal rules for running aground are slightly different for Norse ships.



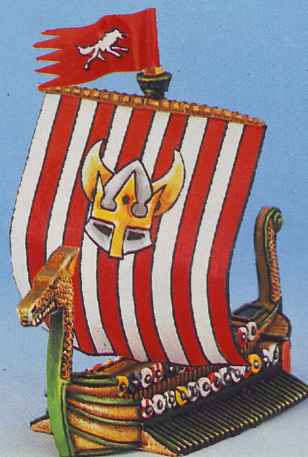
Norse
Longship

NORSE LONGSHIPS AND KINGSHIPS

Old Worlders tell horrifying tales of the berserk Norsemen who loot and burn the ports along the coast in their mighty Kingships and Longships. These sleek vessels can move either under oars or sail and scorn the use of heavy fire-power in favour of high manoeuvrability, so they can strike quickly at the enemy. The Longships in particular excel in boarding actions against other vessels, their decks packed with bloodthirsty warriors able to turn their hands equally to oar or sword.



NORSE LONGSHIP



NORSE KINGSHIP



A NORSE KINGSHIP AND THREE LONGSHIPS SET OUT ON A RAID.

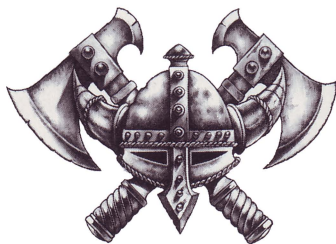
If a Norse ship passes over any part of a sandbank, rocks, a coastal section or an island, it must end its movement for that turn and you must make a below the waterline saving throw. If you fail, you must roll on the following table.

Roll	Damage taken by Norse ship
1	2 below the waterline hits.
2-5	1 below the waterline hit.
6	No damage.

Any Norse ship that starts the battle phase aground may attempt to move off by rolling a dice: on a score of 3 or more the ship may move away freely. If you roll 1 or 2 the ship is stuck fast and stays where it is. It doesn't take any more damage and may try and move again next turn.

COMBAT

Norse ships have no ranged weapons at all, so all they can do during the battle phase is move and board other ships. As it happens, they are very good at boarding actions.



KINGSHIPS

Kingship crews are made up of a number of different warrior classes, though all are soldiers first, sailors second. This doesn't mean that they are poor sailors – far from it; the Norse are amongst the most accomplished seafarers in the Known World. What it does mean is that given the choice between a long voyage or taking part in a bloodthirsty battle, the fight would win every time.

Norsemen who take to the seas in search of treasure, glory and war are usually from one of the following four warrior classes: Ulfwerener, Berserkers, Bondsmen or Huscarls.

The Norse warrior counters supplied replace the normal Man O' War crew counters, which are not used for Norse Kingships.

Norse warrior counters act in exactly the same way as crew counters, in that each adds +1 to your boarding action dice roll, but they also add additional bonuses as detailed below.

Note that anything that affects a crew counter in the Man O' War game, such as magic or critical hits, will affect a Norse warrior counter in the same way. With the exception of their special rules, they are the same as normal crew counters.

Ulfwerener

Ulfwerener means 'Wolf Warriors' and is the word used by the Norse to describe those members of their society who are able to transform their shape into a grotesque half-man half-wolf. Such individuals are quite common in northern Norsca, where whole families of these werewolves live in forest settlements.

Ulfwerener are much feared throughout the Warhammer World as fearsome fighters, whether in man or wolf form. The black and terrible deeds of the Ulfwerener over the years have led to many of the horror stories about the Norse, and have given them a well-deserved reputation for ferocity in battle.

Ulfwerener Special Abilities

If the Ulfwerener are leading a boarding action, roll a dice.

On a 1, 2 or 3 they enter the battle as normal crew, and have no extra effect on the result of the boarding dice rolls.

On a 4, 5 or 6 they leap onto the enemy vessel as ravaging, slaving giant wolves, and add +1 to your boarding dice rolls. In addition, your opponent must roll a dice for each of his crew counters. On a score of 1 it jumps overboard to escape the wolves and is discarded.

Berserkers

These lawless, near uncontrollable, warriors are considered maladjusted even by other Norse Warriors. Before a fight, the Berserkers work themselves into a battle frenzy, ripping and biting at their own clothes and war-gear. In this state they are highly dangerous – not only to the enemy, but sometimes to their own side! A ship that has both Ulfwerener and Berserkers aboard is a fearsome opponent indeed, and any ship coming too close is likely to be boarded and captured with ease.

Berserker Special Abilities

If the Berserkers are leading a boarding action, roll a dice on the following table before the boarding action starts, and again for each subsequent round of the action.

Roll	Berserker Special Ability this turn
1-2	-1 to your boarding dice roll.
3-4	+1 to your boarding dice roll.
5	+2 to your boarding dice roll.
6	Roll again and add that number to your boarding dice roll

Bondsmen

Bondsmen normally make up the majority of warriors aboard a Longship. They are fierce fighters, and show few qualms about laying down their lives in battle.

Bondsmen Special Abilities

If they are leading the combat, Bondsmen give an additional +1 to your boarding dice rolls, whether the Norse are attacking or defending.



A Norse Kingship and three Longships attack a High Elf coastal patrol.

Hurscarls

Hurscarls are the household troops of the Norse Lords. They are maintained and well equipped by their Master, and are fiercely loyal and frenzied fighters. When a Norse Lord takes to the sea, his Hurscarls will go with him. They fight alongside him and share his fortune, be it good or bad. Hurscarls are the defenders of their household banners, and will fight with grim determination to repulse anyone who boards their Lord's ship, giving no thought to their own lives in their efforts to destroy their adversaries.

Hurscarl Special Abilities

Hurscarls give a +1 to boarding dice rolls whilst leading an attack, and +3 when leading a defence.

USING NORSE WARRIOR COUNTERS

At the start of a game, separate the Norse warrior counters and place them in a cup. Give the cup a good shake to shuffle up the counters, and then take five for each Kingship in your fleet.

Before a boarding action, choose one of the counters. This is the warrior class that is leading the fight. The crew get the benefit of this warrior class' special abilities during the combat, whether it is an attack or a defence. (The boarding party get the normal dice roll plus their number as usual, plus the special ability of the leading warrior class.)

For example: a damaged Kingship has four Norse warrior counters left, out of an original five: 2 Berserkers, 1 Hurscarls and 1 Bondsman.

During the game, it attempts to board an Empire Wolfship from the starboard-side; the Norse player decides that the berserkers will lead the attack.

The Norse player gets a dice+4 (1 for each Norse warrior counter in the attack), and rolls a 3, giving a total of 7. He rolls another dice to see what effect the Berserkers have on this total; the result is 4, which means the Berserkers give an extra +1 to the boarding dice roll, for a total of 8.

The Empire player gets a dice +3 (because he has only 3 crew counters), and rolls 4; adding +1 for the broadside cannons, he therefore has a total score of 8.

The combat is a draw and both players lose one crew counter. As the Berserkers were leading the attack, the Norse player must discard one of his Berserker counters.

The initiative passes to the Empire player who decides to counterboard the Kingship. He rolls of 3, adds +2 for his remaining crew counters, giving a total of 5. (Note that as he is attacking, he may no longer add +1 for the cannons.)

The Norse player decides to lead the defence with his Hurscarls. He gets a dice +3 for the number of Norse warrior counters he has left, plus another +3 for the Hurscarls' special defensive ability. He rolls a 5, which gives him a total of 11.

The Norse win the round and the Empire player loses another crew counter.

The Norse player decides to go on the offensive again, this time with his remaining Berserkers leading the attack. He gets a dice +3 for his remaining Norse warrior counters, and rolls a 3, for a total of 6. Rolling a dice for the Berserkers, he gets a 5. This gives him another +2 to his boarding dice, for a grand total of 8.

The Empire player now gets a dice +1, as he only has 1 crew counter left. He rolls a 5, which gives him a total of 6. Although he can add +1 to this for his cannons, giving him a 7, he still loses the fight.

The Empire player is beaten and the Wolfship is captured; the Norse player boards it with his Bondsmen and captures it as a prize. This leaves him with his Hurscarls and his remaining Berserkers onboard his Kingship.

ULFWERENER	ULFWERENER	BERSERKERS	BERSERKERS
ULFWERENER	ULFWERENER	BERSERKERS	BERSERKERS
ULFWERENER	ULFWERENER	BERSERKERS	BERSERKERS
HUSCARLS	HUSCARLS	BONDSMEN	BONDSMEN
HUSCARLS	HUSCARLS	BONDSMEN	BONDSMEN
HUSCARLS	HUSCARLS	BONDSMEN	BONDSMEN

NORSE KINGSHIP



No Ranged Weapons

OARS6"/8"

SAIL6"/9"

Weapons
None

Special Rules
The crew of a Kingship are variable: see *Norse Crews and Boarding Actions* in the main rules.
If a Kingship runs aground and fails a below the waterline saving throw, roll on the following table:

- 1Takes 2 below the waterline hits.
- 2-5Takes 1 below the waterline hit.
- 6No Damage.

The Kingship must then roll a 3 or more to move away freely.

NORSE
KINGSHIP
MAN O' WAR

CREW
5
SPECIAL

3 FIGUREHEAD Save 5 or 6	4,5 MAIN MAST Save 4, 5 or 6 First hit has no effect. Second hit destroys mast. May not move under sail. Any further hits do not cause critical damage.	6 STERN Save 5 or 6
3 PROW Save 5 or 6	4 FORWARD OAR DECK Save 4, 5 or 6 Oars lost. Speed under oars reduced by 3" (4").	5 AFT OAR DECK Save 4, 5 or 6 Oars lost. Speed under oars reduced by 3" (4").
6 AFT Save 5 or 6	BELOW WATERLINE Save 4, 5 or 6 First, second and third hits have no effect. Fourth hit sinks ship.	
NO EFFECT	NO EFFECT	NO EFFECT
SINKS		

OARS: 6"(8")SAIL: 6"(9")

BATTLE HONOURS: 4

Leaning far out over the Dragonprow of his Kingship, Ulfric Grondal shielded his eyes from the spray and pulled his furs around him. Four months earlier he and three other captains had set sail from Norsca in search of booty, plunder and more hospitable climes; four Kingships crammed with proud Norse warriors and their war gear, with enough supplies to last any eventuality. The Legends of the Southlands beckoned them, telling of riches beyond measure that were theirs for the taking.

No one could have foreseen the wild shifts in temperature and the changes in the weather as the ships skirted the Seas of Chaos, nor the all-consuming storms which ravaged the fleet, ripping sails from masts and snapping oars as if they were matchwood. No one had expected the distorting effects of these dread waters on the fabric of time itself and its effect on the men. The four ships had drifted through storms and had been becalmed for months.

Disorientated, tired and hungry, the proud warriors had run the gamut of emotion from frustration and wild-eyed anger, to despair and hopelessness. Now all thoughts of The Southlands were gone from their minds. Their only hope lay in finding land – any land. After months at sea, the Norsemen resembled wildmen or animals: their furs were matted, their chainmail battered and rusty, their faces weather-beaten, and their hair straggling and unkempt.

Squinting through the murky fog bank, Ulfric's suspicions were confirmed: he spotted the hazy outline of a headland, no more than two leagues distant. Turning to face his crew, he cupped weather-calloused hands in front of his mouth to help his words carry over the crash of the waves and the harsh shrieking of the wind.

"Land ahead lads. Make fast for beaching."

The words had a profound effect on the crew; where there had been tired, beaten men, rowing mechanically with no aim or direction, now there were ranks of steely-eyed warriors, shrugging off their fatigue as if waking from a terrible dream.

A wild-looking warrior, clad in thick, matted pelts leapt up beside Ulfric.

"Where are we by your reckoning, Lord?" he addressed Ulfric. His eyes gleamed in anticipation.

Ulfric pointed toward the land, now scarcely ten ships lengths away, before replying in a fierce whisper.

"I know not, Haftagg, but be sure that whatever lives on these accursed shores will feel the wrath of the Ulfwerener before the day is out."

Haftagg grinned wildly, revealing sharply-pointed canine teeth. Throwing his head back, he let out an ear-splitting howl – a feral hunting scream to any that might hear. As one voice his hunting pack in the bows replied, and the sound of howling carried over the water from the three other Kingships.

Soon swords were drawn and shields buckled on, with all thoughts of fatigue or despair forgotten. The Berserkers were nearly uncontrollable, their hideous warcries joining with the rising battlesong of the Huscarls and Bondsmen standing ready at their battlestations.

As the hulls of the ships grated on the sands, Ulfric could see no sign that any alert had been raised by the inhabitants of this gloomy island. The Norse warriors leapt over the side into the freezing, waist high waters as the ships ground to a stop.

Fog swirled about them, and a sharp tide tugged at his legs, but Ulfric laughed and led his men up the beach towards the lights. With swords drawn, and battle lust coursing through their veins, they ran.

There were over a hundred Norse Warriors in all – as fine a fighting force as would be seen anywhere in the Known World. The shadowy forms of the werewolves bounded ahead of the main force, closely followed by the screaming, enraged Berserkers.

The lights of the building loomed near, and through the fog Ulfric discerned a wall. Beyond it huddled what could be a monastery. Pale lights gleamed in the windows and a sad, mournful chanting carried on the wet air. Ulfric urged the Berserkers to smash down the stout gates.

"Take the gold from their foul Gods and sack the monastery. It is their curse which has caused us such hardship, and now they must pay!" Ulfric's voice was a frenzied roar, urging his warriors to heedless violence and retribution.

The gates collapsed inward under the force of the blows, and the Norsemen streamed into the darkened courtyard beyond. Dimly lit figures emerged from the building, their heads bent as if in prayer. Not one of the Norsemen noticed the great gates swing shut behind them, so intent were they on revenge.

Ulfric ran at the head of the Berserkers, screaming with rage and hate. Reaching the cowed figures, his great sword fell in a glittering arc, as it thudded into them again and again. In a few seconds it was done; Ulfric and his men stood panting amongst the bodies of the priests, the mist swirling about them.

"Now," rasped Ulfric. "Now we burn the monastery and take the gold within. Geimdall, you and your Huscarls, take the..."

Ulfric's voice was cut off abruptly as he felt something cold and hard grab his leg. He stabbed at it with his sword. Then the fog cleared for a moment, and Ulfric screamed. He stared at the rictus grin of a long dead skeleton, whose grasping fingers had a firm grip on his ankle. Around him, the cowed corpses began to move. His men backed off, fear in their eyes.

Around the Norsemen the earth was moving, fingers poking through the soft soil like worms surfacing after a rainshower.

"Make for the ships. This is the island of the Lord Morr himself," Ulfric shouted.

He knew he had to stop the retreat becoming a rout. Hacking the skeletal hand at his ankle free, he held it aloft and hurled it into the air.

"Stick together, for our swords smash bone as well as flesh," he shouted, grinning at the nearest warriors. Taking heart, they re-grouped and began a swift retreat to the gates.

But the gates had locked behind them, and this time, Ulfric realised they would not open so easily. All around, cowed figures staggered towards them through the fog.

"Form a shield wall," he cried. "If we are to die, let us go to the Gods with honour, standing on a pile of bones and broken skulls. Unfurl the banner and sound the Warcry; we are Norsemen and will not be taken easily!"

LONGSHIPS

Longships are Norse Ships of the Line that are crewed by Thralls - the lower class of the Norse. Despite their lowly status, Thralls are as bloodthirsty as the rest of Norse society, and relish the chance to suspend the monotony of their daily life for the excitement of battle. When the Norse organise themselves for a major battle, and launch a full scale warfleet, it is the Thralls that make up the bulk of the fighting troops in the fleet.

LONGSHIP SPECIAL RULES

Longships are bought as a squadron of three ships. A squadron of Longships may lash their vessels together to make a kind of fighting platform. To do this, all the ships in the squadron must be touching each other at the end of the battle phase. At the start of their next turn they are considered to be lashed together. While lashed together, a squadron of Longships may not move under oars and has a sailing speed of 4".

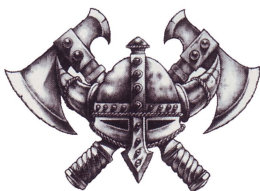
In a boarding action all the ship's crews fight together: three ships lashed together will have nine crew counters in total, for example. Ships that are lashed together must be boarded as one vessel - you cannot capture one of them independently of the rest. However, each ship may be individually fired at and sunk, within the normal limitations for line of sight, etc.

If a Longship that is lashed to other Longships is sunk, its crew may move across onto any of the other ships in the group as long as there is room for them - i.e. at least one of the other ships in the group is at less than full crew strength.

BOARDING ACTIONS

Longships have 3 normal crew counters, and get no special bonuses in boarding actions; they are not crewed by Ulfwerener, Berserkers, Bondsmen or Huscarls.

Longships are worth 2 battle honours.



BUYING NORSE SHIPS

Any fleet may buy Norse ships as allies, as long as they conform with the usual limitations for the fleet. You may never have more than one Kingship for every squadron of Ships of the Line in your fleet. You may never have more than one squadron of Longships for each Man O' War in your fleet.

If you would like a complete Norse Fleet you may use the Fleet List on this page.

NORSE FLEET

A Norse Fleet may consist of the following:

Admiral's Flagship: 1

The fleet must have at least one Kingship to be your Admiral's Flagship.

Cost: 100 points

Men O' War: 1+

At least one Kingship.

You cannot have more Kingships than you have Ship of the Line squadrons.

Cost: 100 points per Kingship.

Ship of the Line Squadrons: 1+

At least one squadron of three Longships.

You cannot have more squadrons of Longships than you have Men O' War, including the Admiral's flagship.

Cost: 150 points per squadron.

Wizard: 1

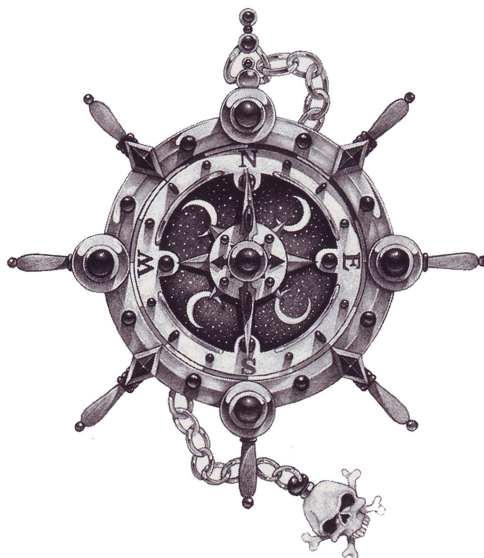
Cost: Variable – see *Wizards and Magic*.

Admiral: 1

Cost: Free.

Men O' War Cards: 1+

Cost: 1st card free with the Admiral's Flagship, subsequent cards at 25 points per card.



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NORSE
LONGSHIP

SHIP OF THE LINE

CREW
3

4 PROW Save 5 or 6	5 MAIN MAST Save 5 or 6 Mast lost. Cannot move under sail. Any further hits do not cause critical damage.	6 STERN Save 5 or 6
3 OAR DECK Save 4, 5 or 6 Oars lost. Cannot move under oars.		
NO EFFECT	SINKS	BELOW WATERLINE Save 5 or 6 First hit has no effect. Second hit sinks ship.

OARS: 6"(8") SAIL: 6"(9")

BATTLE HONOURS: 2

RULE CLARIFICATIONS

Those astute readers who already own a copy of Sea of Blood will note that this version of the Norse Raiders rules contains several minor modifications compared to the same chapter in the Sea of Blood rulebook. While these changes have little effect on the rules themselves in the main they were simple confusions between the words Kingship and Longship), for completeness we have listed all the ammendments below.

On the Kingship template in the rulebook it is listed as a Man O’ War’ while on the card template itself it is described as ‘Independent’. In this case the rulebook is correct and a Kingship is of course a Man O’ War.

In the rulebook, where we talk about using Norse Warrior counters, a Kingship can of course carry five warrior counters as specified on the template. Where it refers to Longships in the example, it should really say Kingship.

In the Norse Fleet summary, we’ve decided that the reference to Admiral’s Kingship is just confusing and you should ignore this completely. The rule is that your fleet must have at least one Kingship to be your Admiral’s Flagship. In the same section, where we refer in the number of Ships of the Line Squadrons you can include in your fleet, the rule is that you cannot have more Squadrons of Longships than you have Men O’ War, and these include the Admiral’s Flagship.

NORSE LONGSHIP

No Ranged Weapons

OARS
6"/8"

SAIL
6"/9"

Weapons

None.

Special Rules

A squadron of Longships may be lashed together to count as one ship in boarding actions. When like this, they may only move under sail, and at 4" per turn.
If a Longship runs aground and fails a below the waterline saving throw, roll on the following table:
1 Takes 2 below the waterline hits.
2-5 Takes 1 below the waterline hit.
6 No Damage.
The Longship must then roll a 3 or more to move away freely.